EXPOSITORY WRITING MASTERCLASS

Ethical Considerations

Ensuring Integrity, Originality, and Credibility in Scholarship

PREPARED BY: HASEEB SHEIKH

Foundation of Integrity

Ethics in expository writing isn't just about rules—it's about the respect for intellectual labor and the pursuit of objective truth.

CORE ETHICAL PILLARS

Originality

Presenting your unique voice while synthesizing existing knowledge without misrepresentation.

Attribution

Providing clear credit to original authors for their specific ideas, data, and structures.

Transparency

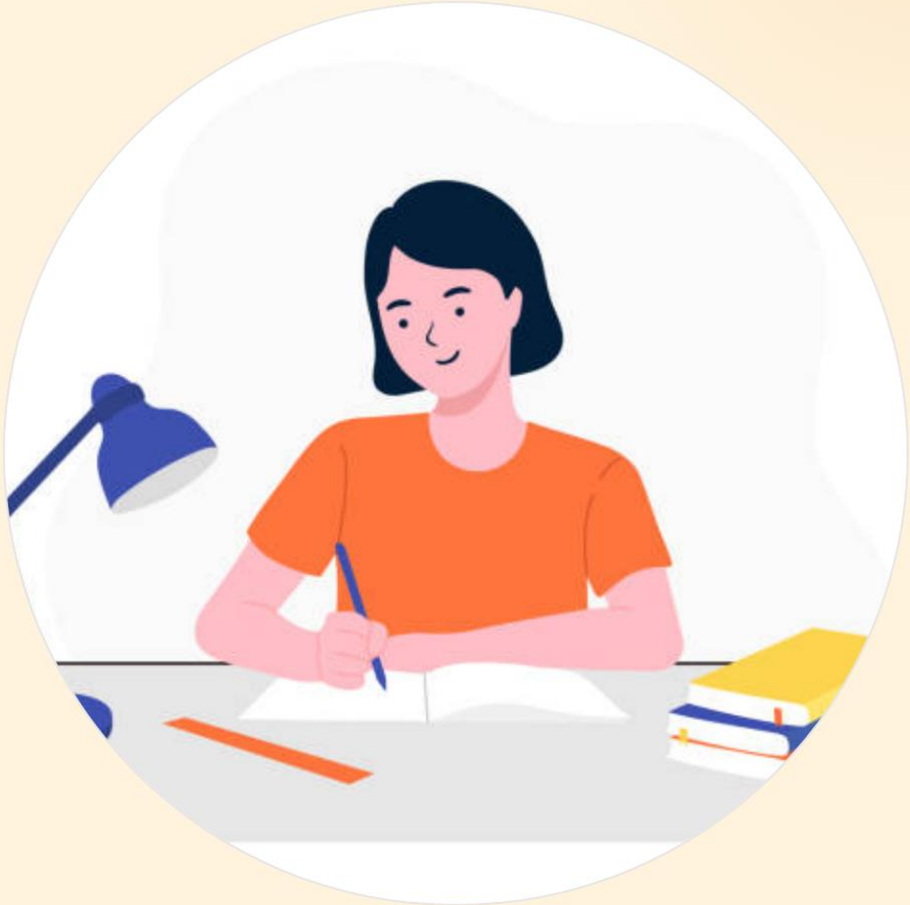
Disclosing potential biases and following standardized citation protocols consistently.

WHAT IS ETHICAL WRITING?

The Scholar's Contract

Ethical writing is the practice of clearly documenting every outside influence used in your work. It creates a "map" that allows readers to trace your research lineage back to its roots.

- Upholds intellectual honesty
- Acknowledges diverse perspectives
- Strengthens personal credibility



ENSURING ORIGINAL WRITING

Research Variety

Relying on a single source is a pathway to unintentional plagiarism. Use a diverse mix of media:

- Peer-reviewed Journals
- Subject-matter Expert Interviews
- Statistical Government Reports
- Scholarly Monographs

Critical Synthesis

Don't just collect information—analyze it. Original writing happens in the "gaps" between your sources.

- Compare contrasting viewpoints
- Identify patterns across studies
- Apply old theories to new data

EVALUATING INFORMATION

The CRAAP Framework

Before citing a source, verify its ethical standing using five critical criteria:

Currency: Is the information timely?

Relevance: Does it fit your specific needs?

Authority: Who is the source creator?

Accuracy: Is the content verifiable?

Purpose: Why was this published?

CITATION STYLE GUIDE

Style	Primary Field	Focus Area	In-Text Format
APA	Social Sciences / Psych	Timeliness (Date)	(Author, Year)
MLA	Humanities / Literature	Authorship (Page)	(Author Page)
Chicago	History / Arts	Source Lineage	Footnotes / Endnotes

**Note: Always consult the latest edition of the specific style manual (e.g., APA 7th Ed).*

INTEGRATION STRATEGIES

From Voice to Evidence

Evidence should support your argument, not replace it. Use these three methods to weave source material into your prose ethically:

Quoting: Exact words for impact or authority.

Paraphrasing: Specific details in your own voice.

Summarizing: Big-picture ideas from large texts.

THE GRAVITY OF INTEGRITY

ZERO

Tolerance Policy

The Consequences

Academic institutions and publishers view plagiarism as the ultimate breach of contract. A single instance can lead to:

- ✕ Grade failure or course dismissal
- ✕ Permanent academic transcript notations
- ✕ Loss of professional reputation and career

ETHICS CHECKLIST

- **Note-taking:** Keep source URLs and page numbers linked to your notes from day one.
- **Visual Cues:** Use different font colors in drafts to distinguish between your words and copied text.
- **The "Common Knowledge" Rule:** When in doubt, cite it. There is no penalty for over-citing.
- **Self-Plagiarism:** Do not repurpose your own previous work without explicit permission and citation.

THE ETHICAL WRITING LOOP

Gather
Find diverse, peer-reviewed sources.

Evaluate
Apply the CRAAP test to every lead.

Synthesize
Draft using paraphrasing techniques.

Finalize
Run through a plagiarism checker.

Questions?

"Integrity is doing the right thing when no one is watching."

Writing Integrity Resource Hub | 2024

IMAGE SOURCES

https://media.istockphoto.com/id/1262582734/vector/happy-girl-studying-with-books-student-girl-at-the-desk-writing-for-her-homework-back-to.jpg?s=612x612&w=0&k=20&c=AiXV4EkEfWsgnIILEkilYyIDVzhefIFckEOhP6wMf50=

Source: www.istockphoto.com

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Source: pngtree.com

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